

Genuine Disadvantage?

Q I have a Compaq laptop and Windows XP with 512 MB of RAM. Recently, when I was surfing the Net, a Windows update was available and I was asked whether to update it or to reject it. I selected the option of updating it, as it was free of cost. Now the problem is that every time I start Windows, it gives me a warning that the Windows what I use is not a genuine one and says that I am a victim of software counterfeiting, and I will be asked to either get genuine or to resolve later. What can I do to avoid that message? Is it possible to cancel that update or delete that?

Dr. Spoorthi

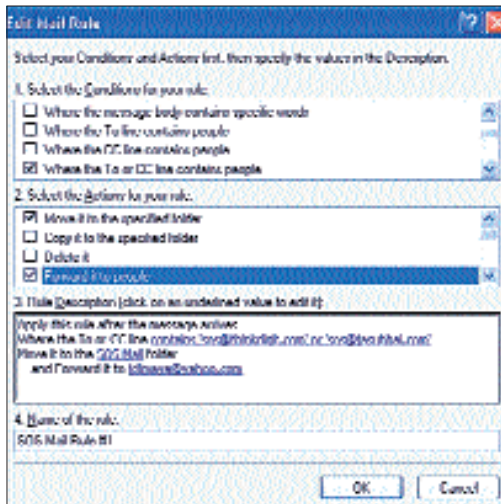
A Windows Update installs the Genuine Windows Component, which verifies whether the copy of Windows XP you are using is legally licensed. If this is the copy of Windows XP your laptop came with, contact Compaq and have them resolve the issue. If, however, it was installed by someone else or you did so yourself, your copy might be

illegal. This is a common case in India, because bootleg copies of Windows XP are often installed by computer “engineers” without the knowledge of the customer.

The solution to this problem is, of course, to buy a legal copy of Windows XP. If you did buy a legal copy of Windows, read on.

On validation failure, you are directed to a page where you are given the details about why the validation failed and what are the recommended steps to be taken to fix the problem. One of the steps lets you check whether you can use the online Product Key Update Tool. If you have Genuine Windows, but it was improperly installed using an invalid product key, this tool allows you to convert your computer to a genuine status without having to purchase a new copy of Windows. If this fails, you should contact the Microsoft Customer Service at <http://support.microsoft.com/gp/contactwga>.

you forward all incoming e-mail to an address of your choice, thereby eliminating the need for Outlook Express altogether. If you do wish to have Outlook Express in the picture, you can set



Forward your messages in Outlook Express by setting up rules

up a message rule. Go to Tools > Message Rules > Mail. Under “Select the Conditions for your Rule”, choose “For all messages”, and under “Actions”, choose “Forward it to people”. In the text box below, the word “People” will be a hyperlink—click on it and you’ll be able to enter your Yahoo! e-mail address.

There are quite a few tools that can convert Real Media files to MP3—for example, SUPER from www.erightssoft.net/S5FO1.html, and WavePad from www.nch.com.au/wavepad.

Installation Imbroglio

Q I have a system with a PIV 2.4 GHz processor, Intel chipset Mercury board, 128 MB RAM, 40 GB hard drive. I have a problem installing any software to Win98 SE; also, while installing from the mainboard CD, I get the error 0x80070725: “Incompatible version of the RPC stub.” This started while installing jetaudio-6.

Sudhan Kum

A The error is caused by an incompatible version of a DLL file that was installed on the system by different programs. Oleaut32.dll, Olepro32.dll, Asycfilt.dll, Stdole2.tlb are some of the common DLL files.



The jetAudio installation error

The error is most likely a bad version of oleaut32.dll. Follow the directions below to remove and reinstall this file. Since this resolution requires you to modify the System folder, we advise you to observe extreme caution: one wrong step may cause serious problems.

Download the following DCOM (Distributed Component Object Model) file: <http://support.installshield.com/kb/files/Q105810/dcom98.exe>. Select Start > Shutdown > Restart in MS-DOS mode. Enter the following commands at the command prompt:
`CD c:\windows\system`
`rename oleaut32.dll oleaut32.old`
`exit`

Windows will restart automatically. Ignore the error message “A required .DLL file, C:\windows\system\oleaut32.dll, was not found.” Log in as you normally would, and double-click on the DCOM file to install the new version of oleaut32.dll. Restart after the installation is complete.

Poof!

Q On pressing [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Del], I find that the Task Manager button has gotten disabled.

Arnab Deb

A There could be two reasons for this. One of the reasons: the account you use has been blocked via the “Local Group Policy” or “Domain Group Policy”. To re-enable the Task Manager, run Gpedit.msc. Navigate to User Configuration > Administrative Templates > System > Ctrl+Alt+Del Options. Set the